Course Overview

This course provides a complete, end-to-end training program for the Freight Management Team (FMT), specifically focusing on the "Dashboard 02 (DB2) Refresh" process. The training is designed for new team members with zero prior knowledge of logistics, project cost management, or the specific software systems used. It covers fundamental business concepts, detailed system navigation, and a step-by-step breakdown of the entire project refresh workflow, from initial setup to final cost reporting.

Learning Objectives

Upon completing this training, you will be able to:

1. **Understand Core Concepts:** Define key logistics and project management terminology, including the different dashboards (DB0, DB1, DB2, DB3) and the phases of a solar project.
2. **Navigate Key Systems:** Locate and download critical files from Mfx (Matrix Factor), Anaplan, and NetSuite.
3. **Execute the DB2 Refresh Workflow:** Independently perform all steps of a project refresh, including:
    - Preparing project folders and downloading necessary reports.
    - Conducting a "BOM vs. Allocation" check.
    - Building a dashboard template with shipment and invoice data.
    - Matching invoices to shipments and handling exceptions.
    - Estimating costs using rate sheets.
    - Forecasting future container counts.
    - Adding data to the central Project Logistics (PL) Dashboard.
    - Preparing a project summary.
4. **Identify and Resolve Exceptions:** Recognize common errors and exceptions in the data (e.g., mismatched project numbers, duplicate invoices, missing drayage invoices) and apply the correct resolution procedure.
5. **Apply Business Rules:** Follow standard operating procedures, such as applying a 5% buffer on rates, using standard estimation percentages for different container types, and preparing weekly summaries.
6. **Understand Business Impact:** Recognize why this process is critical for financial reporting, project profitability analysis, and supply chain efficiency.

Business Context

The Freight Management Team (FMT) is responsible for managing the logistics costs for large-scale solar projects. The primary purpose of the team is to create and maintain freight cost dashboards for each project, providing an accurate view of costs from the initial budget stage all the way through to final project closure.

Why is this process important?

- **Financial Accuracy:** The dashboards are used by Finance, Project Managers (PMs), and senior leadership (including the VP of Supply Chain) to track project profitability and make informed decisions.
- **Cost Control:** By continuously refreshing project data and matching invoices, the team ensures that all freight costs are accurately captured. This helps in identifying cost overruns, validating freight forwarder charges, and ensuring that any extra costs are approved before payment.
- **Stakeholder Transparency:** The dashboards and summaries provide a single source of truth for all stakeholders involved in a project's lifecycle, from operations to finance.
- **Continuous Improvement:** The DB2 refresh process is a continuous cycle. Projects are refreshed quarterly (or more often) to keep costs up-to-date, moving them toward final closure (DB3).

Key Stakeholders

- **FMT:** The team responsible for the process described in this training.
- **Finance Team:** Uses the dashboard data for accounting and financial reporting.
- **Project Managers (PMs):** Approve high-cost shipments (e.g., air freight) and extra charges.
- **Logistics Coordinators (LCs):** Execute the shipments and approve extra costs.
- **Sourcing Team:** Creates the initial budget (DB0) and negotiates rates with freight forwarders.
- **Freight Forwarders:** The logistics providers who physically move the goods (e.g., DSV, Hellmann, Kerry, Geodis, BNSF).

Definitions of All Terms

- **Dashboard 0 (DB0):** The budgeted cost for a project, as per the sales estimate. This is the original freight cost expected.
- **Dashboard 1 (DB1):** The estimated cost, created once a project is 100% allocated to vendors. It uses the current contracted rates for all required items.
- **Dashboard 2 (DB2):** The refresh cycle process (the focus of this course). It is a continuous process that is used once shipments start moving and invoices start coming in. It is a mixture of actual costs (invoices received) and estimated costs (for shipments where invoices are not yet received), plus forecasts for future shipments.
- **Dashboard 3 (DB3):** The actual final cost of the project. It is created when all shipments are complete, all invoices are received, and the project is commissioned. This is the "project closure" stage.
- **BOM (Bill of Materials):** A complete list of all material items required for a project.
- **Allocation:** The assignment of BOM items to specific vendors and freight forwarders to be shipped in specific weeks.

- **Container Count:** The total number of shipping containers required to transport a project's materials.
- **Megawatt (MW):** A unit of power used to describe the size/capacity of a solar project. DG projects are typically under 25 MW; utility projects are larger.
- **Bill of Lading (BOL):** A unique identifier for each shipment. It is a legal document issued by a freight forwarder to a shipper that details the type, quantity, and destination of the goods being carried.
- **SFC Number:** The internal "Shipment, Freight, Container" number, another unique identifier for a shipment.
- **Container Number:** The unique identifier of a physical shipping container.
- **ETD (Estimated Time of Departure):** The date a cargo is scheduled to depart from the origin port.
- **POD (Point of Destination/Port of Discharge):** The destination port where the container arrives.
- **POL (Point of Loading):** The origin location where the cargo is loaded onto a vessel.
- **Drayage (Last Mile):** The movement of a container by truck from the destination port (POD) to the final project site.
- **DDP (Delivered Duty Paid):** An incoterm where the vendor is responsible for all costs and risks to deliver the goods to the final destination, including freight, duties, and drayage.
- **CIF (Cost, Insurance, and Freight):** An incoterm where the vendor pays for the cost, insurance, and freight to bring the goods to the destination port. The buyer is responsible for drayage.
- **Incoterm:** A set of standard trade terms defining the responsibilities of buyers and sellers for the delivery of goods, including costs and risk.
- **Extra Cost:** Additional charges beyond the standard freight cost, such as detention, demurrage, layover fees, wait time, and storage charges.
- **Fuel Surcharge (FSC):** A variable surcharge added to freight costs to account for fluctuations in fuel prices.
- **Rate Sheet:** A file containing the pre-negotiated rates for transportation (ocean, drayage, truckloads) with specific freight forwarders for different lanes.
- **Ad-hoc Shipment:** A shipment that is not part of the original plan, often executed on an emergency basis.
- **Spot Quote:** A one-time price quote for an ad-hoc shipment.
- **Reclass:** The process of correcting an invoice from an incorrect project number to the correct project number to ensure accurate financial accounting.
- **Credit Note:** A document issued by a freight forwarder to cancel or reduce the amount of a previously issued invoice (e.g., a duplicate or incorrectly billed invoice).

- **Red Sea Surcharge:** A temporary surcharge added to ocean freight rates due to the geopolitical situation causing shipping disruptions in the Red Sea region.

Important Concepts

Project Lifecycle and Dashboards

The dashboards represent the lifecycle of a project's freight costs.

- **Budgeting (DB0):** The project is priced for the sales team. This is the budgeted freight cost.
- **Estimation (DB1):** The project is allocated to vendors. The cost is now estimated using current market rates, replacing the initial budget.
- **Tracking (DB2):** The project is in execution. This is the continuous refresh cycle. Actual invoices are mixed with estimates.
- **Closure (DB3):** The project is completed. This is the final actual cost, used for project profitability analysis.

The DB2 Refresh Process

This is the core workflow you will learn. It's a systematic process of verifying data from multiple systems and incorporating it into a single, accurate dashboard.

Start of the Week:

1. **Download master files:** Shipment Export, Booking Export.
2. **Download Master Allocation File:** From Anaplan.
3. **Download Invoice Dump:** From Efrate (weekly).
4. **BOM vs Allocation Check:** Compare what is needed (BOM) to what is assigned (Allocation).

For Each Project:

1. **Prepare Project Folder:** Create a folder and download the necessary reports.
2. **Build Template:** Add shipment data from the Shipment Export.
3. **Add Invoice Data:** Import the weekly invoice dump.
4. **Match Invoices:** Run the template to match invoices to shipments.
5. **Handle Exceptions:** Resolve mismatches in BOL, SFC, or project numbers.
6. **Estimate Missing Costs:** Use rate sheets to estimate costs for shipments where invoices are not yet received.
7. **Forecast Future Shipments:** Add container counts for booked/forecasted shipments.
8. **Update PL Dashboard:** Copy the final working table into the central PL Dashboard file.
9. **Prepare Summary:** Write a summary explaining the changes in the cost from the previous refresh.

Reason for Surge Surcharges

Due to the Red Sea crisis in early 2024, ocean shipping rates have increased. The team must add surcharges to all ocean estimates for shipments loaded after January 1st, 2024. This is a temporary business rule.

Complete Step-by-Step Workflow

Step 1: Preparation and Folder Structure

1. **Create a Project Folder:** On your local drive, create a new folder for the specific project you will refresh. A common naming convention is "DB2 - [Project Name]". This folder will contain all your working files, including the template, downloaded reports, and rate sheets.
2. **Download Master Files (Start of Week):**
    - Navigate to the Mfx/Matrix Factor system.
    - Go to **Logistics > Shipment Export**.
        - Set the date range. The standard is from 2020-01-01 to 2025-12-31.
        - Click **Export** to download the file.
    - Go to **Logistics > Booking Export**.
        - Use the same date range and export.
    - Go to **Cost Center** to get the Extra Cost Report.
        - You can search for the specific project number and export it, or export the complete list.
    - **From Anaplan:**
        - Navigate to the **Master Allocation** module.
        - Click on the three dots and select **Export > Excel** to download the complete allocation dump.
    - **From NetSuite:**
        - Navigate to the **BOM Tracker** report. You can export the complete dump or filter by a specific project name.
    - **From Box:**
        - Download the latest rate sheets and the weekly invoice dump (F Payline Report).

Step 2: BOM vs. Allocation Check

Purpose: To ensure that all required project materials (BOM) are assigned to a vendor (Allocation). This is a critical check to prevent cost inaccuracies.

Process:

1. **Prepare BOM Data:**
    - Open the BOM report you downloaded from NetSuite.

- Filter the data for your specific project number or name.
- Copy the filtered data into a new workbook or worksheet. Name the sheet BOM.
- **Delete Non-Logistics Items:** Remove all rows where the parent item is Engineering Services, Commissioning Services, etc. These are not logistics-related.
- **Fix Data Formats:** Ensure the Item/Part Number column is in a "Number" format for accurate lookups.

2. **Prepare Allocation Data:**
   - Open the Master Allocation file you downloaded from Anaplan.
   - Filter the data for your project number or name.
   - Copy the filtered data into the same workbook as the BOM data. Name the sheet Allocation.
   - **Create a Pivot Table:** Select the allocation data and create a Pivot Table.
     - **Rows:** Dream Part Number (the item part number).
     - **Values:** Total Pieces (or the quantity field).
   - This pivot table summarizes the total allocated quantity per item, even if it's assigned to multiple vendors.
3. **Perform VLOOKUP:**
   - In the BOM sheet, create a new column for Allocation Quantity.
   - Use VLOOKUP to pull the total allocated quantity from the pivot table you just created.
     - =VLOOKUP(Item Number Cell, Allocation Pivot Table Range, Column Number for Quantity, FALSE)
   - Replace any #N/A errors with 0 to indicate no allocation.
4. **Calculate Delta:**
   - Create a new column called Delta.
   - = BOM Quantity - Allocation Quantity.
5. **Analyze Delta:**
   - A Delta of 0 means the item is fully allocated. Good.
   - A small, non-zero Delta (e.g., a few hundred pieces for parts like fasteners) is usually insignificant as it's a very small quantity. It won't impact the container count.
   - A large Delta (e.g., for major components like Talk Tubes) is a significant problem. You must place the project on hold and inform your lead or planner. The project cannot be refreshed accurately until it is fully allocated.

Step 3: Build the Dashboard Template

Purpose: To create a structured workbook where shipment data can be matched against invoice data.

1. **Create a New Template:**
    - You can copy the standard template provided by the FMT.
    - Name the file in a standard format: DB2 - [Project Name].
2. **Update Invoice Data (Efrate Input Tab):**
    - Open the weekly invoice dump file (F Payline Report) from Box.
    - If you don't have the macro, you can use the file provided by the FMT lead, but you should understand the process:
        - Open the Macro Staging file.
        - Go to the Efret tab and copy the headers.
        - Copy all the data from the F Payline Report and paste it into the Efret tab.
        - Run the macro (named Efret).
        - **Clean Data:** In the macro's output, fix the BOL column by converting it to "Number" format. Also, ensure the date columns are in a standard short date format.
    - Copy the cleaned data from the macro output.
    - Go to the Efret Input tab in your project template.
    - **Turn off automatic calculations:** Go to Formulas > Calculation Options > Manual.
    - Delete all existing data below the headers.
    - Paste the new invoice data.
    - **Handling Blank BOLs:** If a row has a blank BOL, manually add a period (.) or a - to prevent it from matching with blank shipment entries.
    - Save the file.
3. **Add Shipment Data (Nexm Input Tab):**
    - Open the Shipment Export file.
    - Filter for your project number or name.
    - **Turn off automatic calculations:** Ensure the formula mode is on Manual.
    - Go to the Nexm Input tab in your project template.
    - Delete all existing data.
    - Copy the relevant columns from the Shipment Export and paste them into the template:
        - Project Number
        - Project Name

        - Container Number
        - **Bill of Lading (BOL):** It's critical to remove all spaces from this data. Use Find and Replace to replace spaces with nothing.
        - SFC Number
        - ATA to Site Date
        - Forwarder (Primary Freight Forwarder)
        - Secondary Freight Forwarder
        - Transportation Type
        - Container Type
        - Cargo Ready Date
        - Allocation Week
        - Vendor Input Term (Incoterm)
        - POL (Point of Loading)
        - POD (Point of Destination)
    - Save the file and turn calculations to Automatic to see the initial matching results.

Step 4: Invoice Matching & Exception Handling

Purpose: To match the invoice data with the shipment data and identify any missing or misattributed costs.

1. **Review 'Efret Check' Column (Column B):**
    - **Value = "BOL match":** The shipment is matched to an invoice. Proceed to check the freight line.
    - **Value = "No BOL match":** No invoice was found in the data. This needs investigation.
2. **Investigate "No BOL Match":**
    - **Common Reason 1: BOL Format Differs.** Freight forwarders often add prefixes or suffixes to the BOL when billing (e.g., adding an "S" for DSV).
        - **Solution:** Copy the incorrect BOL from the template. Go to the Exceptions sheet.
        - In the first table, under the Nexm Voil column, paste the incorrect BOL.
        - In the Master Voil column, paste the correct BOL (the one you found in the invoice data).
        - This creates an "override" rule. The template will now treat the incorrect BOL as the correct one for matching.
    - **Common Reason 2: No Invoice Generated.** If the BOL format is correct and it doesn't match, it might not have been invoiced yet.

        - **Solution:** Add a comment in the Nexm Input tab for that shipment (e.g., "Invoice Not Received"). You will estimate this cost.
    - **Common Reason 3: Mismatched Project Number.** Sometimes the invoice is in the system but billed to the wrong project number. Check the Efret Input tab by filtering for the BOL. If it's attached to a different project number, you must process a reclass. (See Step 5, Reclass Process).
3. **Check for Duplicate or Incorrect Invoices (**Efret Input **tab):**
    - For each freight forwarder that has a "BOL match", filter the Efret Input tab by that forwarder.
    - **Count Check:** Use a COUNTIF formula to see if the number of freight line items matches the number of containers.
    - **Credit Notes:** Sometimes a forwarder issues an invoice, then a credit note, then a new invoice. In the E-frate system, all three appear. You must use the correct one. If you see duplicates, you must manually adjust.
    - **Extra Costs:** Freight forwarders often bill extra costs (like detention) in the "Freight" line item as well as adding them separately in Mfx. This would cause a duplication.
        - **Solution:** To prevent duplication, you must unmatch the "extra cost" line from the freight invoice.
        - Go to the Efret Input tab.
        - Filter by the project number.
        - Find the line item with the extra cost (e.g., a "Detention" charge that is matched to a BOL).
        - **Manually Change the BOL:** Add a text suffix like _EXTRA to the BOL in the Efret Input tab for that line. This will un-match it from the shipment's freight cost.
        - Add a note in the Notes column: Removed Extra Cost - Project Name.
    - **Check for Freight Line Item:** It's not enough that a BOL matches. Ensure you have the main "Freight" invoice. The forwarder may have matched a surcharge, but the main freight invoice could be missing. If missing, add a note: Ocean Confirmed (or Drage Estimated).

Step 5: Reclass Process

Purpose: To correct invoices that have been billed to the incorrect project number.

1. **Identify Mismatch:** When searching the Efret Input tab for a shipment, you find an invoice, but the Project Number column shows a different project number.
2. **Log the Error:**
    - Open the Reclass tracking file (maintained on Box).
    - Add a new row.

- Enter the:
    - **Amount:** The invoice amount to be moved.
    - **Incorrect Project Number:** The project number currently on the invoice.
    - **Correct Project Number:** The project number it should be moved to.
    - **Invoice Number:** The invoice number.
    - **Provider:** The freight forwarder.
    - **Your Name:** (as the requestor/owner).
    - **Date Given:** The date you are adding this request.
- This file is sent to the finance team periodically (usually bi-weekly or monthly) for them to make the reclassification in the accounting system.

Step 6: Rate Estimation

Purpose: To calculate the estimated cost for shipments with "No BOL match" or where the main freight line was missing.

1. **Understand the Source Data:**
    - **Ocean Rates:** Use the Container Rate Sheets. Determine the POL and POD from the shipment data, then look up the contracted rate for that lane and the relevant freight forwarder.
    - **Drayage Rates:** Use the Drayage Rate Sheet. Determine the POD (rail ramp or seaport) and the project's destination site to find the appropriate rate.
    - **Domestic Truckloads (FTL/LTL):** Use the Inland Rate Sheets (Drive & Ftr or Flatbed). Calculate the distance between the vendor's location (POL) and the project site. Multiply the distance by the rate-per-mile and add the fuel surcharge.
    - **FedEx Shipments:** A standard estimate of $200 for domestic or $1,000 for overseas.
    - **Mexico Cross-Border:** Use a standard estimate of $3,000 for the cross-border leg from Mexico to Laredo, TX, plus US drayage rates from Laredo to the site.
2. **Apply Standard Estimation Rules:**
    - **5% Buffer:** For most estimates, add a 5% buffer to the standard contracted rate to account for minor fluctuations and unexpected accessorial charges. **(Note: This buffer is temporarily being removed for ocean freight impacted by the Red Sea surcharge).**
    - **Container Ratios:**
        - 20ft Container: Estimate as **80%** of the 40ft rate for the same lane.
        - LCL (Less than Container Load): Estimate as **50%** of the 40ft rate.
        - FTL (Full Truckload): Full rate from the truckload sheet.
        - LTL (Less than Truckload): Estimate as **50%** of the FTL rate.

3. **Apply Red Sea Surcharge (Temporary Rule):**
    - This applies only to **Ocean** shipments loaded **after January 1st, 2024**.
    - **DO NOT** add the standard 5% buffer.
    - Add the lane-specific surcharge (found in the dedicated surcharge rate sheet) to the base ocean freight rate before adding the drayage.
4. **Update Template:** Manually input the estimated rates into the CSP Output tab. Highlight all manually edited cells in yellow to easily identify estimates in the future.

Step 7: Forecasting

Purpose: To add container counts and cost estimates for shipments that are still in the future (forecasted), preventing the project cost from suddenly jumping when they ship.

1. **Identify Forecasted Shipments:**
    - Open the Booking Export.
    - Filter for your project.
    - Look for shipments with a status other than "Onboarded" or "Cancelled" (e.g., "Booked", "Confirmed").
2. **Validate with Allocation:**
    - Cross-check the forecasted items against the Master Allocation file to confirm the material is still allocated and hasn't already been shipped.
3. **Estimate Container Count:**
    - **Ocean Shipments:** Use the Container Count Table from Anaplan. Filter for the project and vendor to find the planned container count and type.
    - **Domestic Shipments:**
        - **Manual Method:** Use the Packaging List to find the quantity per container for the specific part. Divide the total allocated quantity by this number to get the number of containers.
        - **Container Count Calculator:** Use the internal tool if available.
    - **Air Shipments:**
        - For emergency shipments, check for spot quotes. If no spot quote exists, estimate the rate using the standard methods.
4. **Add to Dashboard:**
    - Go to the CSP Output tab in your template.
    - Add a new row for the forecasted shipment.
    - Fill in the container type and count.

- Use the appropriate rate estimation method (including Red Sea surcharges if applicable) to calculate the cost.
- In the Notes column, clearly mark the status as **"Forecasted"**.

Step 8: Update the Internal PL Dashboard

Purpose: To transfer all your finalized data from the template into the shared Project Logistics (PL) Dashboard file.

1. **Lock the Shared File:**
   - Go to the Box folder containing the Logistic PL Dashboard Internal file.
   - Lock the file for editing to prevent any conflicts.
2. **Download and Update:**
   - Download the PL Dashboard file.
   - Go to the Flat Data tab.
   - **Turn off automatic calculations:** Set to Manual.
   - **Clean Old Data:** Remove all previous rows associated with the project you are updating.
   - **Copy New Data:** Go to the CSP Output tab of your template. Select all the rows for your project and copy them.
   - **Paste and Format:** Paste the new data into the Flat Data tab.
     - **Important:** Ensure the 40ft containers are added before the 20ft containers for the same vendor. This is a required sorting convention.
     - Ensure the Notes column uses the exact standard statuses (Confirmed, Ocean Confirmed - Drage Estimated, Forecasted) so the summary formulas work correctly.
   - After pasting, drag down the formulas in the Index and A Line columns to match the number of rows you added.
3. **Upload and Unlock:**
   - Remove all filters from the Flat Data tab.
   - Save the file and upload it back to Box.
   - Unlock the file for others to use.

Step 9: Prepare Project Summary

Purpose: To provide a clear, high-level summary of the cost changes for the updated project. This is presented to internal teams and shared with finance.

1. **Open the Summary File:** Open the weekly summary file (e.g., Summary - Week XX).
2. **Create a New Entry:**

- Insert a new row for your project.
- The row will contain formulas. Ensure you carry forward the formulas from the row above.

3. **Fill in Required Data:**
   - **Project Name & Number:** Copy from your template.
   - **DB0 & DB1 Costs & Dates:** Get these from the Project List tab of the PL Dashboard.
   - **Current DB2 Value:** The current cost from the Flat Data tab (often column Y in the summary file).
   - **Previous DB2 Value:** Find the last time this project was refreshed (usually by searching for the project number in the summary file) and copy the previous DB2 cost.
4. **Analyze and Write Comments:**
   - Look at the deltas (percentage change vs DB0 and the previous DB2 value).
   - **If cost went down:** Explain why (e.g., "Ocean container rates decreased by 50%", "We were able to source locally instead of overseas").
   - **If cost went up:** Explain why (e.g., "Additional air shipments were required due to project urgency", "A new Red Sea surcharge was applied", "Changes in allocation resulted in more containers").
5. **Share:** Upload the updated summary file to Box.

Software Navigation

The process relies on several key software systems. The following table summarizes the primary functions of each.

System	Purpose	Key Reports/Tasks
Matrix Factor (Mfx)	The primary execution and tracking system. Used to download shipment and booking data.	Shipment Export, Booking Export, Extra Cost Report (from Cost Center).
Anaplan	The planning and allocation system. Used for budget, forecasting, and tracking allocations.	Master Allocation, Logistics Container Count, Packaging Item Records.
NetSuite	The enterprise resource planning (ERP) system. Used for financial data and BOM (Bill of Materials).	BOM Report, Project Details (to check status like "Construction" or "Commissioned").

System	Purpose	Key Reports/Tasks
Efrate	The invoice management system. Holds all freight invoices.	F Payline Report (the invoice dump).
Box	File storage and sharing. Contains all standard templates, rate sheets, and final dashboards.	Logistic PL Dashboard Internal, Rate Sheets (Ocean, Drayage, Inland), Reclass Tracker, Template folder.

Field-by-Field Explanation

Since the template is complex, the most critical fields are explained below. This is not an exhaustive list of every column.

Nexm Input Tab (Shipment Data)

Column / Field Name	Purpose	Source	Action Required
Master BOL	The corrected/exact BOL used to match invoices. This is a formula field.	Exception sheet.	None. This is auto-calculated.
Efret Check	Indicates if an invoice has been matched to this shipment. BOL match is good; No BOL match requires action.	Formula.	If No BOL match, investigate.
BOL (Bill of Lading)	The unique shipment ID. Used for primary invoice matching.	Shipment Export.	**Critical:** Must be pasted and cleaned (remove spaces).
Container No.	The unique ID of the physical container. Used for drayage invoice matching.	Shipment Export.	Paste as is.
SFC (Shipment Freight Container) No.	Internal tracking number. Useful as a secondary search term.	Shipment Export.	Paste as is.
ATA Site	Actual arrival date of the shipment at the project site.	Shipment Export.	Used as a check: If the shipment arrived

Column / Field Name	Purpose	Source	Action Required
			months ago and no invoice is found, follow up with the forwarder.
Forwarder	The primary freight forwarder for the ocean leg.	Shipment Export.	Important for applying the correct rate.
Secondary Freight Forwarder	The freight forwarder for the drayage (last mile) leg.	Shipment Export.	Important for applying the correct rate.
Container Type	Type of container/shipment (40FT, 20FT, FTL, LTL, AIR).	Shipment Export.	Determines which rate to apply in estimation.
PO L (Point of Loading)	Origin city/country.	Shipment Export.	Critical for rate lookups.
PO D (Point of Destination)	Destination port or rail ramp.	Shipment Export.	Critical for rate lookups, especially for drayage.

CSP Output Tab (Final Data)

This tab is the final, consolidated output that gets copied into the PL Dashboard.

- **Container Count:** The number of containers for that line.
- **Freight Cost:** The total cost for that line.
- **Notes: Critical Field.** Uses standard text like Confirmed, Ocean Confirmed - Drage Estimated, or Forecasted to categorize the cost. This drives other summary calculations and determines if manual estimation is needed.

Exceptions Sheet

Column / Field Name	Purpose	Source	Action Required
Nexm Voil	The incorrect BOL as it appears in the Shipment Export.	Nexm Input Tab.	Enter the BOL from the shipment data.

Column / Field Name	Purpose	Source	Action Required
Master Voil	The correct BOL as it appears in the invoice (Efret Input).	Efret Input Tab.	Enter the BOL from the invoice data. This overrides the incorrect one.

Business Rules

1. **Project Selection:** Prioritize projects based on the last refresh date (oldest first). Focus on projects without a DB3 (are still active).
2. **Estimation Buffer:** Add a 5% buffer to all estimated rates (except when the Red Sea surcharge rule applies).
3. **Container Ratios:**
    - 20ft Container = 80% of 40ft rate.
    - LCL Shipment = 50% of 40ft rate.
    - LTL Shipment = 50% of FTL rate.
4. **Order of Adding Data:** In the PL Dashboard's Flat Data tab, for the same vendor, always add 40ft containers first, then 20ft, then LCL.
5. **Estimation Sources:**
    - Ocean Shipments: Container Rate Sheets.
    - Drayage: Drayage Rate Sheet.
    - Domestic Truckloads: Inland Rate Sheet (Drive & Ftr or Flatbed).
    - FedEx: Standard estimate ($200 for domestic, $1,000 for overseas).
    - Mexico Cross-Border: Standard estimate ($3,000 to Laredo, TX).
    - Air Shipments: Use spot quotes if available, otherwise contact the sourcing team.
6. **Red Sea Surcharge Rule:** For ocean shipments with an ETD (Estimated Time of Departure) after January 1st, 2024:
    - **DO NOT** add the standard 5% buffer.
    - **DO** add the lane-specific surcharge.
7. **Data Protection (Box File):** Always lock the central Logistic PL Dashboard Internal file on Box before editing it, and unlock it immediately after you have uploaded your changes. This prevents version conflicts.
8. **Project Closure (DB3):** A project can be moved to DB3 (actual costs) when all shipments have been executed, all invoices are received, and the project status is "Commissioned" or "Closed" in NetSuite.

Decision Logic

Determining Project Status

1. **Is the project 100% allocated?**
    - **YES:** It can be a DB1 project.
    - **NO:** It is a candidate for DB2.
2. **Are all shipments complete and invoices received?**
    - **YES:** It is a DB3 project.
    - **NO:** It is a DB2 project.

Handling "No BOL Match"

1. **Has the shipment reached the site (ATA Site)?**
    - **YES (more than 2-3 months ago): Decision:** The invoice is likely missing or incorrect. Drop a mail to the freight forwarder to request the invoice. **Action:** Add a comment "Invoice Not Received". Estimate the cost.
    - **NO (or recently arrived): Decision:** The forwarder likely hasn't raised the invoice yet. **Action:** Add a comment "Invoice Not Received". Estimate the cost for now. You will match it in a future refresh.

Handling Duplicate Invoices

1. **Can you identify a duplicate invoice?**
    - **YES: Decision:** Check if the freight forwarder has issued a credit note for one of them. If they have, you must ignore the incorrect one and estimate if needed.
    - **NO: Decision:** Consider the invoice valid.

When to Place a Project on Hold

1. **Run BOM vs. Allocation check.**
    - **Is there a significant delta for a major part (e.g., Talk Tubes)?**
    - **YES:** Place the project on hold immediately. Email the planning team or your lead to understand when it will be allocated. Do not proceed.
    - **NO:** Proceed.

Examples Explained

Example 1: Invoice Matching Exception (DSV)

- **Scenario:** You have a shipment with the BOL ABC123, but the Efret Check column shows "No BOL match."
- **Investigation:** You know that DSV often adds an "S" to the BOL when they bill (e.g., ABC123S). You go to the Efret Input tab and search for ABC123. You find an invoice with the BOL ABC123S and a freight charge.

- **Resolution:**
    1. Copy the incorrect BOL from the Nexm Input tab (ABC123).
    2. Copy the correct BOL from the Efret Input tab (ABC123S).
    3. Go to the Exceptions sheet.
    4. Under the first table (Nexm Voil), paste ABC123.
    5. Under the Master Voil column, paste ABC123S.
    6. Turn the calculations back to Automatic. The "No BOL match" will now change to "BOL match". You have successfully created an exception rule that will apply automatically in future refreshes.

Example 2: Removing Extra Cost Duplication

- **Scenario:** In the Efret Input tab, a 100 invoice for a line item with the BOL ABC123 is being matched to the shipment. You have already added the same 100 extra cost to the project in Mfx. This will lead to the cost being counted twice.
- **Resolution:**
    1. Go to the Efret Input tab.
    2. Filter the Provider column for the specific forwarder and the BOL ABC123.
    3. Find the line for the extra cost (e.g., "Detention" or "Layover Fee").
    4. In the BOL column for that specific line, change the BOL from ABC123 to ABC123_EXTRA (or any text that breaks the match).
    5. In the Notes column, add a comment: Removed Extra Cost - Mfx.
    6. Now, the line with ABC123_EXTRA will no longer match the shipment, but the main freight invoice for ABC123 will still match, preventing duplication.

Common Mistakes

- **Mistake:** Not cleaning the BOL data of spaces in the Nexm Input tab before pasting. This causes failed matches.
- **Mistake:** Forgetting to turn off automatic calculations before making major updates to large files. Excel will freeze and crash.
- **Mistake:** Adding estimated rates directly into the Nexm Input tab, rather than the CSP Output tab. All estimates and final data must go through the CSP Output table.
- **Mistake:** Forgetting to add a note when manually editing a cost (estimation, removal of extra cost). This makes it impossible to audit or understand the logic later.
- **Mistake:** Failing to lock the PL Dashboard file on Box before editing it. This can cause data loss if someone else edits the file simultaneously.
- **Mistake:** Applying the 5% buffer to ocean rates that already have the Red Sea surcharge applied. This overestimates costs.

- **Mistake:** Adding forecasted shipments that don't have a supporting allocation. This will lead to inaccurate container counts.

Troubleshooting

- **Issue:** Excel is slow or crashing.
    - **Solution:** Ensure Formulas > Calculation Options is set to Manual before making any changes (filtering, copying, pasting). Only turn it back to Automatic after you have saved your work.
- **Issue:** A shipment's BOL is not matching, even after trying the BOL, SFC, and Container Number.
    - **Solution:** Search the Efret Input tab by the project number only. If you find an invoice with no BOL or a different BOL, you can manually create an exception. If you find nothing, the invoice hasn't been received yet. Estimate the cost and document it.
- **Issue:** You see an invoice value that seems drastically wrong.
    - **Solution:** This could be a duplicate. Check if the freight forwarder has issued a credit note. If they have, you must use the correct invoice and ignore the credit note. Add a note explaining the situation.
- **Issue:** The project has a large delta in the BOM vs Allocation step.
    - **Solution:** This is a critical issue. Do not proceed. Stop the project and immediately inform your team lead. The project is not ready to be refreshed.

Tips and Best Practices

- **Be Proactive with Exceptions:** Create exception rules for frequent issues (like DSV's "S" suffix) instead of manually fixing them every time. This saves significant effort in future refreshes.
- **Maintain a Personal Template:** Once you have a well-populated template for a project, save it. Next time you refresh that project, you can reuse it, only needing to update the invoice data and check for new shipments/exceptions.
- **Use Standard Comments:** Stick to the standard statuses in the Notes column (e.g., Confirmed, Ocean Confirmed - Drage Estimated, Forecasted). This is critical for other reports and dashboards to work correctly.
- **Document Everything:** A single comment like Estimate - 5% buffer applied can be invaluable when you revisit the file months later or during an audit.
- **Practice with Real Projects:** The concepts become much clearer when you are working on a real project. Use the practice files provided by the trainer to get hands-on experience.
- **Learn the Systems Inside and Out:** The more comfortable you are with Mfx, Anaplan, and NetSuite, the faster you can locate the data you need.

Shortcuts

- **Excel Formula Calculations:**

    - F9: Force a full recalculation of the workbook.
    - Shift + F9: Force a recalculation of the active worksheet only.
    - **Turning on Manual Mode:** Formulas -> Calculation Options -> Manual. This is the most important shortcut to prevent crashes.
- **Excel Navigation:**
    - Ctrl + C: Copy.
    - Ctrl + V: Paste.
    - Ctrl + (grave accent): Show formulas instead of values in cells.
- **Finding Data:** Become fast at using Ctrl + F (Find) in your workbooks to search for specific BOLs, project numbers, or comments.
- **Data Cleaning:**
    - Ctrl + H: Open Find and Replace. Use this to quickly replace spaces in BOL columns.

Interview Questions with Answers

Q1. What is the purpose of the DB2 Dashboard Refresh?
A1: The DB2 refresh is a continuous process to track and report the actual and estimated freight costs of a project. It ensures that the project cost is always up-to-date, accounting for invoices that have been received and estimates for future or uninvoiced shipments.

Q2. Explain the difference between DB0, DB1, DB2, and DB3.
A2: DB0 is the initial budgeted cost from sales. DB1 is the estimated cost based on current rates, used once the project is allocated. DB2 is the continuous refresh cycle, mixing actual invoices and estimates. DB3 is the final actual cost, completed after project closure.

Q3. What is the "BOM vs. Allocation" check and why is it important?
A3: The BOM vs. Allocation check compares what materials are needed for a project (BOM) to what has been assigned to vendors (Allocation). It's important to ensure all required materials are accounted for. A large delta (mismatch) would cause an inaccurate cost estimate and must be resolved before the project can be refreshed.

Q4. How do you handle an invoice that has a "No BOL match"?
A4: First, try to search for the invoice using the SFC Number or Container Number. If found, check if the BOL is different (e.g., has a prefix or suffix) and create an exception in the Exceptions sheet. If the invoice is not found at all, add a comment "Invoice Not Received" and estimate the cost for that shipment.

Q5. What are "extra costs" and why are they manually removed from the invoice data?
A5: Extra costs are additional charges like detention, demurrage, or wait times. They are manually removed from the invoice data (unmatched) because they are already being tracked and reported separately in the Mfx "Extra Cost" report. If you didn't remove them, the same cost would be counted twice.

Q6. What is the "Reclass" process?
A6: The Reclass process is used when an invoice is billed to the incorrect project number. We track these incorrect invoices in a separate file and send it to the finance team to correct the accounting in the financial system.

Q7. What is a standard buffer and why is it used?
A7: A standard 5% buffer is applied to estimated rates to account for small cost fluctuations, accessorial charges, and billing discrepancies, preventing the dashboard cost from fluctuating wildly between refreshes.

Q8. How do you estimate a 20ft container when you only have a rate for a 40ft container?
A8: A 20ft container is estimated at 80% of the 40ft rate. An LCL shipment is estimated at 50% of the 40ft rate.

Q9. What is a "Red Sea Surcharge" and when do you apply it?
A9: It's a temporary surcharge added to ocean freight costs due to shipping disruptions in the Red Sea region. It's applied to ocean shipments with a loading date (ETD) on or after January 1, 2024. When this surcharge is applied, the standard 5% buffer is **not** added.

Q10. How do you forecast a project's container count?
A10: You use the Booking Export to identify booked shipments. For ocean shipments, you get the count from the Container Count Table in Anaplan. For domestic shipments, you manually calculate using the Packaging List or the Container Count Calculator tool.

Q11. What steps do you take to prepare a project summary?
A11: Open the weekly summary file. Add a new row for the project. Copy over the previous and current DB2 costs. Analyze the difference to the previous value and the original budget (DB0). Write a concise comment explaining the reasons for any increase or decrease in cost (e.g., rate changes, additional forecasts, new extra costs).

Q12. Why is it important to lock the PL Dashboard file on Box before editing it?
A12: Locking the file prevents version conflicts. If you upload changes to an unlocked file, you risk overwriting another team member's updates. It's a standard business practice to prevent data loss.

Q13. What do you do if you find a duplicate invoice?
A13: A duplicate invoice usually means a credit note has been issued. You would need to check with the billing team to confirm this and ensure you are using the final, correct invoice. If a credit note exists, you should exclude the incorrect invoice from your calculations.

Q14. What is the difference between a "Primary" and "Secondary" freight forwarder?
A14: The primary forwarder handles the main leg of transportation, typically the ocean freight from the origin port to the destination port (POD). The secondary forwarder handles the "last mile" or drayage, moving the container from the POD to the final project site.

Q15. Where do you get the freight rates for estimation?
A15: We use rate sheets stored on Box. There are specific sheets for Ocean, Drayage, and Domestic truckloads (FTL/LTL/Flatbed). For ad-hoc or air shipments, we use "Spot Quotes" that are also stored on Box.

Q16. How do you calculate a domestic LTL rate?
A16: An LTL (Less than Truckload) rate is estimated as 50% of the FTL (Full Truckload) rate for the same lane.

Q17. What is the purpose of the Exceptions **sheet in the template?**
A17: The Exceptions sheet is used to create manual overrides for inconsistent data. For example, if a freight forwarder consistently adds a suffix to the BOL on invoices, you can tell the template to automatically use the suffix when matching, saving you time in every future refresh.

Q18. What is the "CSP Output" tab used for?
A18: The CSP Output tab is the final, cleaned, and consolidated data that is ready to be copied into the central PL Dashboard. It contains all the costs, container counts, and notes in the exact format required.

Q19. What is "Fulfillment" and how is it used?
A19: Fulfillment refers to the percentage of the total sales order (SO) that has been executed/shipped. A project with 100% fulfillment is likely in its final stages, making it a candidate for DB3 closure (if all invoices are also received).

Q20. You find a shipment with "No BOL match" that was delivered 6 months ago. What do you do?
A20: This is a serious issue. Since the shipment has been delivered for a long time, the freight forwarder should have invoiced us. I would first check all possible search criteria (SFC, Container Number). If I still can't find it, I would immediately email the freight forwarder, including all shipment details (BOL, SFC, Project Number), asking them to provide the missing invoice urgently. I would also add a comment "Invoice Not Received" and estimate the cost to ensure the dashboard is not massively underreported.

Real Job Scenarios

Scenario 1: The Urgent PM Request\

- **Situation:** A Project Manager urgently requests the latest cost for an active project to present to a client.
- **Task:** The data in the PL Dashboard is two months old. You need to perform a full DB2 refresh for that specific project.
- **Resolution:** Follow the complete workflow for that project. The BOM vs. Allocation check should be quick. The longest part will be the invoice matching and estimation. Once complete, upload the new data to the PL Dashboard and update the summary. Notify the PM that the dashboard is updated.

Scenario 2: Major Allocation Change\

- **Situation:** The planning team informs you that they have re-allocated 25% of a project's talk tubes from an ocean vendor to a domestic vendor.
- **Task:** This will change the cost and container count. The allocation file is updated, but the Booking Export and Shipment Export are not yet fully updated.

- **Resolution:** Download the new Master Allocation file. Use this to manually adjust your forecast for the project. You will need to estimate the new domestic costs and adjust your container count accordingly. The change might also trigger a new summary comment.

Scenario 3: The Persistent Exception\

- **Situation:** Every time you refresh a project for a specific freight forwarder (e.g., "Geodis"), you find that 50% of their drayage invoices don't match. They bill by a "Warehouse Reference" number, not the standard BOL, SFC, or Container Number.
- **Task:** You cannot change the freight forwarder's billing format, but you also can't spend 2 hours on the same manual matching for every refresh.
- **Resolution:** You need a new permanent solution. You discover from the forwarder that the Warehouse Reference number corresponds to the SFC number. You add an exception rule for Geodis in your template, telling it to match their invoices using the SFC number from the Shipment Export.

Scenario 4: The Missing Air Freight Invoice\

- **Situation:** You are refreshing a project. There are 3 air freight shipments with "No BOL match." You search by BOL, SFC, and Container Number. You find one invoice by SFC, but the other two are missing.
- **Task:** Complete the refresh for the project.
- **Resolution:** For the matched air shipment, you confirm the invoice. For the two missing ones, you check the ATA to Site date. They arrived two weeks ago. You drop an email to the air freight forwarder. You add the invoices as "Air - Invoice Not Received" and estimate them using the standard air freight estimation method. You note in your summary that two air invoices are pending.

Scenario 5: Invoiced to the Wrong Project\

- **Situation:** During your invoice matching, you find a $50,000 invoice with a correct BOL for your project, but the invoice is billed to a different project number.
- **Task:** Correct this issue.
- **Resolution:** Since the invoice is correct, you can match it for your own dashboard. However, Finance won't see this cost against your project. To fix the finance books, you add this invoice to the Reclass tracking file and send it to Finance. You will also add a note in your project template explaining that a Reclass is pending.

Scenario 6: Spotting a Major Duplicate\

- **Situation:** You are matching invoices for a project and notice the same $10,000 freight invoice appears twice in the Efret Input tab.
- **Task:** You must ensure the cost is only counted once.
- **Resolution:** You check if a credit note has been issued. You don't find one. You note the duplicate and email the freight forwarder and your billing team to flag the duplicate. To

complete your refresh, you ignore one of the invoices by adding a suffix to the BOL in the Efret Input tab (_DUP). You add a clear note explaining this action. The cost is only counted once.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1: I don't have access to Matrix Factor. What should I do?
A: Access requests are typically handled through your IT or onboarding. Let your trainer or lead know, and they can escalate the access request.

Q2: The Excel file is taking too long to calculate. What can I do?
A: This is a common issue. Ensure the workbook is in Manual Calculation mode before you start working. Only switch to Automatic when you absolutely need to see the updated results after you've saved your work.

Q3: What is the first thing I should do when starting a new project refresh?
A: Download all the necessary files (Shipment Export, Booking Export, Master Allocation, BOM, Latest Invoice Dump, Rate Sheets) and create a dedicated folder for the project. The pre-work is crucial for an efficient workflow.

Q4: How do I know which rate sheet to use?
A: The correct rate sheet depends on the type of shipment:

- **Ocean:** Container Rate Sheet.
- **Drayage (Port to Site):** Drayage Rate Sheet.
- **Domestic Truck (FTL/LTL):** Inland Rate Sheet (Drive & Ftr for general freight, Flatbed for items like talk tubes).
- **Ad-hoc:** Spot Quote file.

Q5: Can I just "round up" container counts?
A: Yes. If a calculation shows 7.6 containers, you should round up to 8, as you cannot ship a fraction of a container. This is a standard business practice.

Q6: Why do some projects have multiple project numbers?
A: In Europe, there is often an "Interco" project (for intra-European shipments) and a main "International" project. They are combined in the dashboard to give a single, total cost view for the project.

Q7: What is an "Ad-hoc" shipment?
A: An ad-hoc shipment is any shipment that was not part of the original plan. It's typically an emergency or unplanned move (e.g., shipping critical parts by air to a site to avoid a construction delay).

Q8: Who updates the rate sheets?
A: The Sourcing Team (e.g., Akshay, Mohammed). They negotiate rates with the freight forwarders and update the master rate sheets in the Box folders.

Q9: How do I know if a project is ready for DB3 (Project Closure)?
A: A project is considered ready for DB3 when:

1. All shipments are completed.

2. All invoices are received and matched.
3. The project status in NetSuite is "Commissioned" or "Closed."
4. There are no pending allocations or forecasted shipments.

Q10: What if I make a mistake and update the PL Dashboard with the wrong data?
A: First, don't panic. You can lock the file again, download the latest version, and revert the incorrect changes using your backup template. If the mistake was uploaded for a while, the best practice is to immediately correct it and update the summary file, explaining the correction.

Key Takeaways

1. **Accuracy is Paramount:** The entire process is built on ensuring every cost is correctly attributed to the right project. Small data errors (like a space in a BOL) can lead to significant manual rework.
2. **The Process is Your Protection:** Following the steps diligently, especially the BOM vs Allocation check and the Exceptions Sheet, creates a robust, auditable trail for all project costs.
3. **Know Your Systems:** The speed and accuracy of your work depend heavily on your proficiency with Mfx, Anaplan, NetSuite, and Excel.
4. **Communication is Key:** You are a central hub of logistics cost data. You must communicate issues to freight forwarders, the billing team, and your stakeholders (PMs, LCs).
5. **Document Everything:** Good notes and comments are the difference between a useful tool and a source of confusion. Always document your estimates and exceptions.
6. **The Bigger Picture:** This isn't just data entry; it's a critical part of financial and operational oversight. Your work directly impacts the company's ability to manage costs, bid on new projects, and demonstrate profitability to investors and the board.
7. **Embrace Exceptions:** Every project is unique. Don't be frustrated by inconsistencies; view them as opportunities to create permanent, time-saving exceptions.

Complete Glossary

Term	Definition
Ad-hoc Shipment	An unplanned, emergency shipment.
Allocation	The assignment of materials to a specific vendor and a specific shipping week.
Anaplan	The primary planning and allocation system.
ATA to Site	Actual date the shipment arrived at the project site.

Term	Definition
Bill of Lading (BOL)	A unique identifier for a shipment.
BOM (Bill of Materials)	The complete list of all materials required for a project.
Box	The company's shared file storage and collaboration system.
Container Count	The number of shipping containers used to transport materials.
Container Number	The unique ID of the physical shipping container.
Credit Note	A document issued to cancel or reduce an invoice.
Dashboard 0 (DB0)	The initial freight budget.
Dashboard 1 (DB1)	Estimated freight cost after 100% allocation.
Dashboard 2 (DB2)	The continuous refresh cycle (a mix of actual and estimated costs).
Dashboard 3 (DB3)	The final, actual freight cost after project closure.
DDP (Delivered Duty Paid)	An incoterm meaning the seller pays all delivery costs to the final destination.
Drayage	The movement of a container by truck from the port to the project site
Efrate	The system used to receive and validate freight invoices.
ETD (Estimated Time of Departure)	The date a cargo is scheduled to leave the origin port.
Exception	A scenario where the data doesn't match perfectly (e.g., different BOL formats) requiring a manual override.
Extra Cost	Charges beyond the basic freight, like detention, demurrage, and layover fees.

Term	Definition
Forecast	An estimate of a future shipment that has been booked but not yet shipped.
Freight Forwarder	A company that arranges the transportation of goods.
FSC (Fuel Surcharge)	A variable charge added to cover fluctuations in fuel prices.
FTL (Full Truckload)	A shipment that fills an entire truck.
Incoterm	An international trade term defining responsibilities for shipping, cost and risk.
LCL (Less than Container Load)	A shipment that does not fill a full container.
LTL (Less than Truckload)	A shipment that does not fill a full truck.
Matrix Factor (Mfx)	The primary system for tracking and executing shipments.
Megawatt (MW)	A unit of power, used to define the size of a solar project.
NetSuite	The company's Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) system.
POD (Point of Destination/Port of Discharge)	The destination port.
POL (Point of Loading)	The origin location where cargo is loaded.
Project Manager (PM)	The person responsible for the overall project, often approving major costs.
Rate Sheet	A file containing contracted freight rates for specific lanes and services.
Reclass	Correcting an invoice from an incorrect project number to the correct one.

Term	Definition
Red Sea Surcharge	A temporary surcharge on ocean freight due to the 2024 Red Sea crisis.
SFC Number	Internal "Shipment, Freight, Container" tracking number.
Sourcing Team	Team responsible for negotiating rates with freight forwarders.
Spot Quote	A one-time price for an ad-hoc or unique shipment.

Quick Revision Sheet

1. **Process Flow:**
    - **Start of Week:** Download all files (Mfx, Anaplan, NetSuite, Box).
    - **Pre-Check:** BOM vs. Allocation.
    - **For Each Project:**
        - Build Template (Add Shipment & Invoice Data).
        - Match Invoices (Check Efret Check column).
        - Handle Exceptions (Exceptions sheet, Reclass, remove extra costs).
        - Estimate Missing Costs (5% buffer, standard ratios, Red Sea surcharge).
        - Forecast Future Shipments (Booking Export + Allocation).
        - Update PL Dashboard (Flat Data tab).
        - Prepare Summary (Analyze and comment on cost changes).
2. **Key Estimation Rules:**
    - **20ft = 80% of 40ft**
    - **LCL = 50% of 40ft**
    - **LTL = 50% of FTL**
    - **FedEx = $200 (domestic) / $1,000 (overseas)**
    - **Mexico Cross-Border = $3,000**
    - **Buffers:**
        - **Standard:** Add a 5% buffer to all estimates.

        - **Red Sea Surcharge (Ocean, ETD > Jan 1, 2024):** Do not add 5% buffer. Add the lane-specific surcharge.

3. **Key Red Flags (Stop and Investigate):**
    - **Large delta in BOM vs. Allocation.**
    - **"No BOL match" for shipments over 6 months old.**
    - **Duplicate invoices.**
    - **Invoices billed to the wrong project number.**

Daily Work Checklist

Start of Week:

- Download Shipment Export from Mfx.
- Download Booking Export from Mfx.
- Download Master Allocation file from Anaplan.
- Download BOM from NetSuite (if needed for new projects).
- Download the latest invoice dump (F Payline Report) from Box.
- Download the latest Rate Sheets from Box.

For Each New Project:

- Create a project folder (e.g., DB2 - [Project Name]).
- Copy the latest template into the folder.
- Run the BOM vs. Allocation check. (Stop and escalate if there is a large delta.)

For Each Project Refresh:

- Update the Efret Input tab with the new invoice dump.
- Update the Nexm Input tab with the Shipment Export data.
- **Crucial:** Turn calculations to Manual before copying/pasting.
- **Match Invoices:** Check the Efret Check column.
- **Handle Exceptions:**
    - Add BOL exceptions to the Exceptions sheet.
    - Remove extra costs from matching.
    - Log Reclass errors in the Reclass tracker.
- **Estimate:** Fill in the CSP Output tab for all No BOL match or missing freight line items using the rate sheets.
- **Forecast:** Add any future shipments to the CSP Output tab.

- **Update PL Dashboard:**
    - Lock the PL Dashboard file on Box.
    - Copy data from CSP Output to the Flat Data tab.
    - Drag down formulas.
    - Save and upload the file.
    - Unlock the PL Dashboard file.
- **Prepare Summary:** Add the project to the weekly summary file and write a comment on the cost changes.

End of Week:

- Share the weekly summary file with the team.

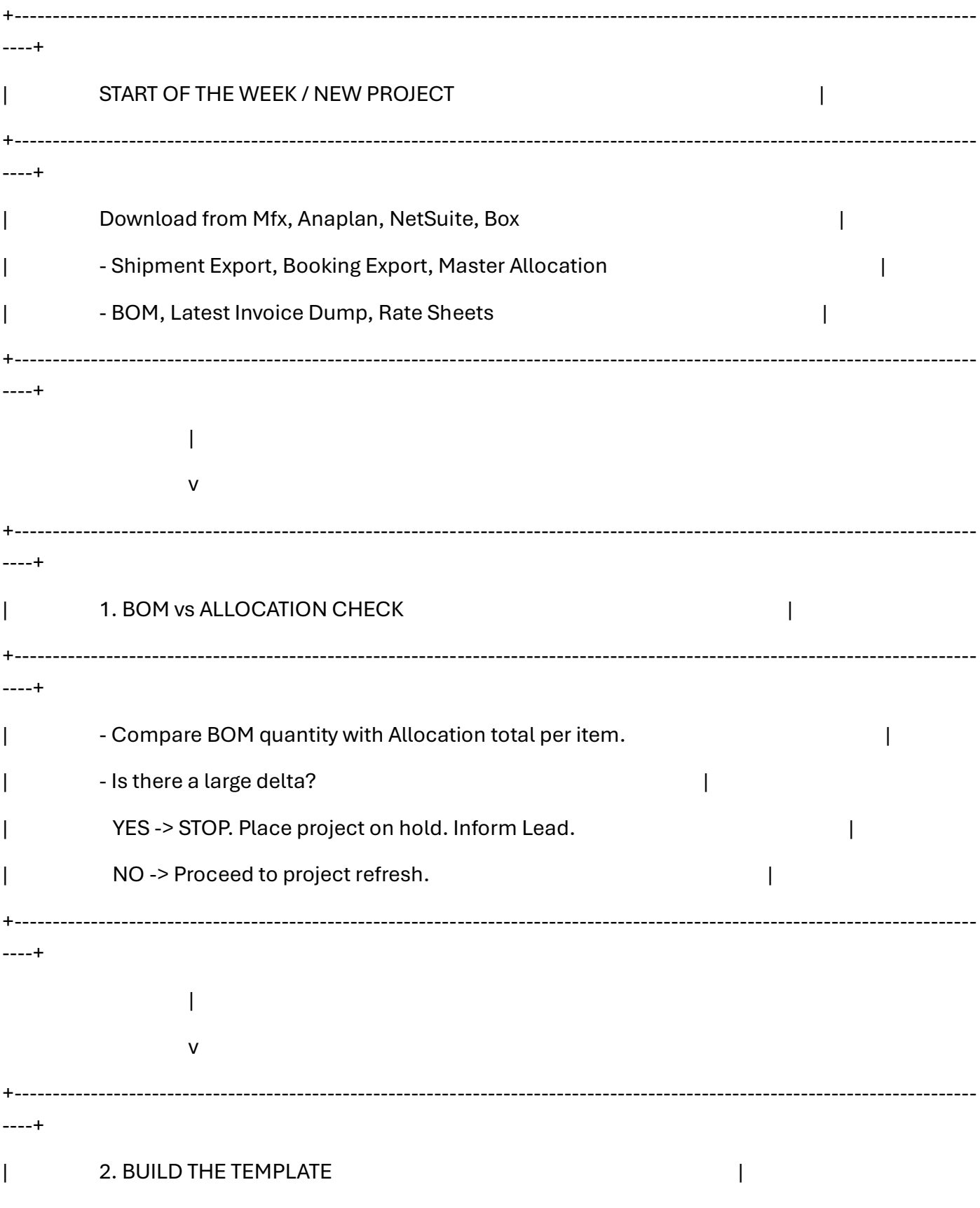
Beginner Cheat Sheet

- **Step 1: The Golden Rule:** When working with large Excel files, **ALWAYS** set Formulas > Calculation Options to Manual. This prevents crashes and freezing. Remember F9 to recalculate manually.
- **Step 2: What to do when a BOL won't match:**
    1. Try the SFC number.
    2. Try the Container number.
    3. Check if the forwarder added a prefix/suffix (look for a pattern, e.g., DSV adds "S").
    4. If found, create an Exception.
    5. If NOT found, estimate it.
- **Step 3: The Three Data Sources for Rates:**
    1. **Ocean:** Container Rate Sheet
    2. **Drayage (Port to Site):** Drayage Rate Sheet
    3. **Domestic (Truckloads):** Inland Rate Sheet
- **Step 4: The Four Key Statuses (for the** Notes **column):**
    1. Confirmed (Invoice received and matched).
    2. Invoice Not Received (Shipment done, no invoice found yet).
    3. Ocean Confirmed - Drage Estimated (Main ocean invoice received, but drayage is estimated).
    4. Forecasted (Shipment hasn't happened yet).
- **Step 5: Common Estimation Shortcuts:**
    - If you need a 20ft rate and only have 40ft -> **80%** of 40ft.

- If you need an LCL rate -> **50%** of 40ft.
- If you need an LTL rate -> **50%** of FTL.

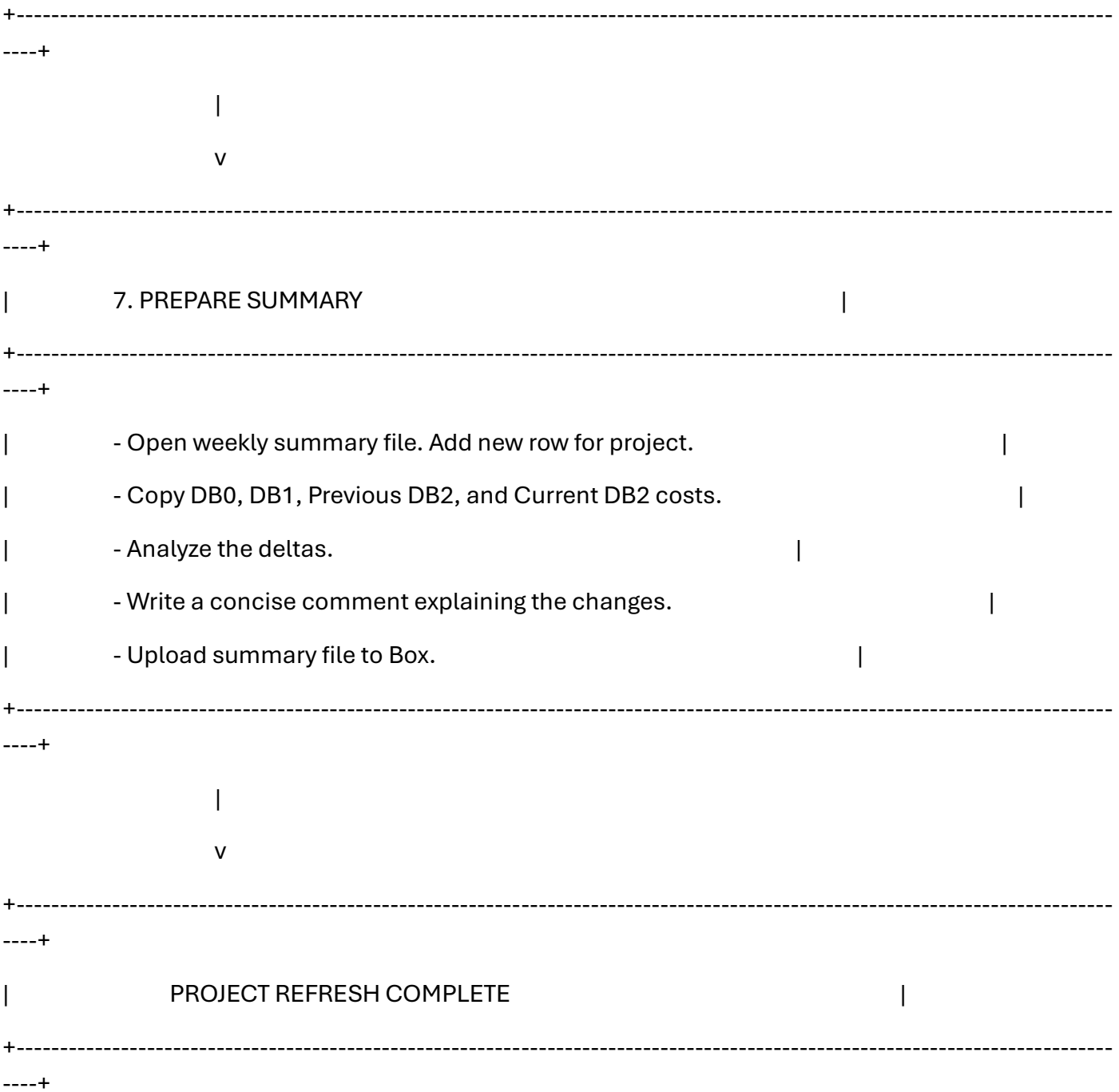
End-to-End Workflow Diagram (ASCII Flowchart)

text



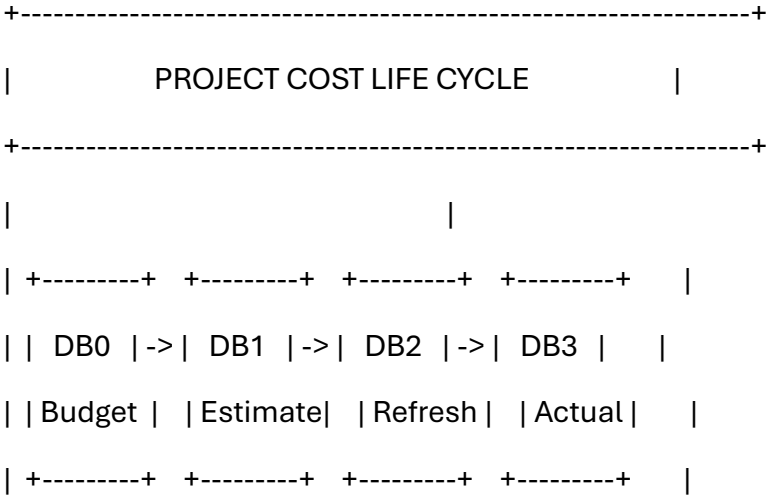
```
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
----+
|          - Create "DB2 - [Project Name]" file.                                                                                      |
|          - Update Efret Input tab with new invoices (Manual Calcs ON).                                                             |
|          - Update Nexm Input tab with Shipment Export data (Manual Calcs ON).
|
|          - Turn calculations to AUTO to see initial matches.                                                                       |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
----+
                        |
                        v
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
----+
|          3. INVOICE MATCHING & EXCEPTION HANDLING                                                                                  |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
----+
|          - For each shipment in Nexm Input, check 'Efret Check' column:                                                            |
|          - BOL Match -> Proceed to check cost lines.                                                                               |
|          - No BOL Match -> Is the invoice found by SFC or Container No?                                                            |
|                YES -> Create an Exception rule.                                                                                    |
|                NO -> Add "Invoice Not Received" in Notes.                                                                          |
|          - Remove extra costs by breaking the match in Efret Input tab.                                                           |
|          - Identify if any invoices are billed to the wrong project -> Log Reclass.                                               |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
----+
                        |
                        v
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
----+
|          4. RATE ESTIMATION                                                                                                        |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
----+
|          - For all "Invoice Not Received" or missing freight lines:                                                               |
```

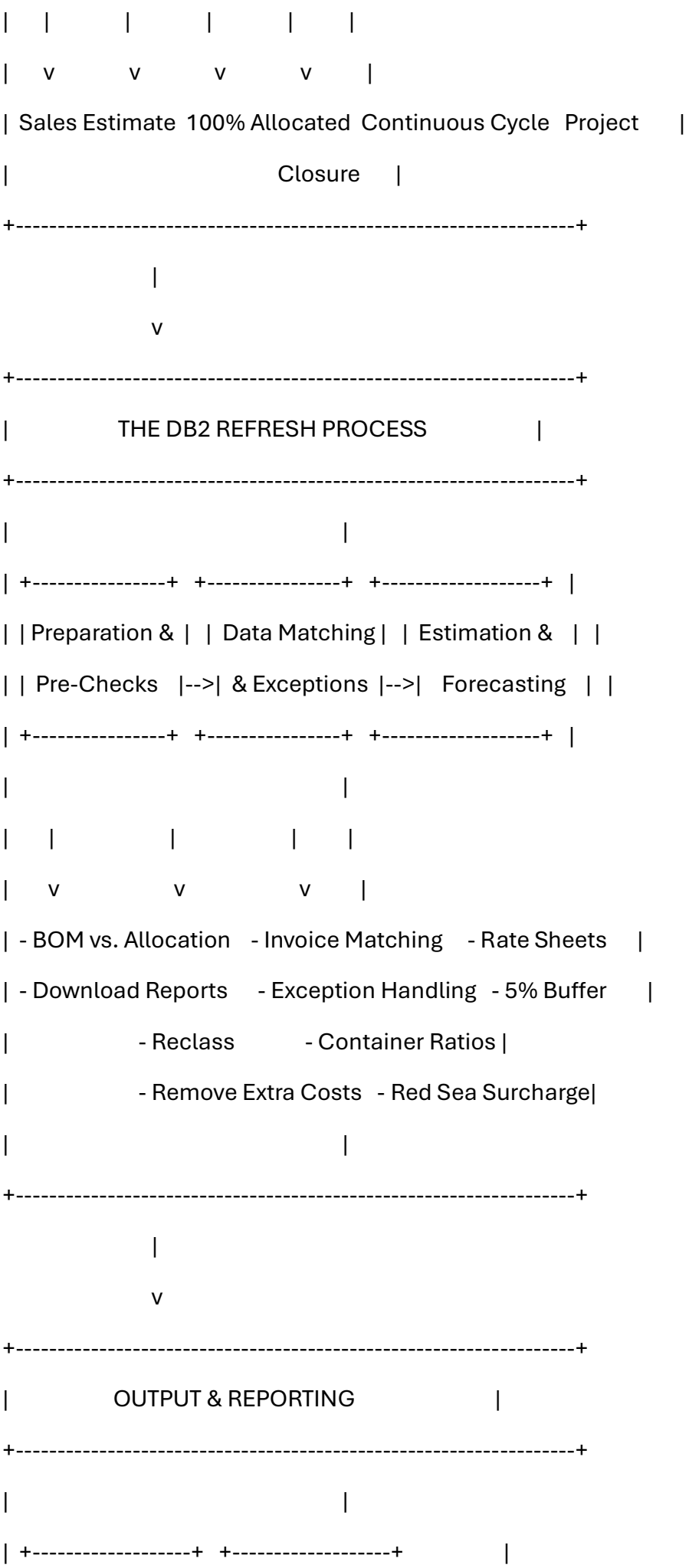
```
|          - Use the correct rate sheet (Ocean, Drayage, Inland) to calculate cost.                    |
|          - Apply standard estimation rules (5% buffer, container ratios, etc.)                      |
|          - For Ocean ETD > Jan 1, 2024: Add Red Sea surcharge. DO NOT add 5% buffer.
|
|          - Input estimated rates into the CSP Output tab.                                          |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
----+
                          |
                          v
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
----+
|          5. FORECASTING                                                                            |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
----+
|          - Review Booking Export for future "Booked" shipments.                                    |
|          - Validate with Master Allocation file.                                                   |
|          - Calculate forecasted container counts using Container Count Table or manual methods.
|
|          - Add forecasted lines to CSP Output tab, marked as "Forecasted" in Notes.
|
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
----+
                          |
                          v
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
----+
|          6. UPDATE PL DASHBOARD                                                                    |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
----+
|          - Lock the PL Dashboard file on Box.                                                      |
|          - Copy all rows from CSP Output tab.                                                      |
|          - Paste into Flat Data tab of PL Dashboard (Manual Calcs ON).                             |
|          - Drag down Index and A-Line formulas.                                                    |
|          - Remove filters, save, upload, unlock file.                                              |
```

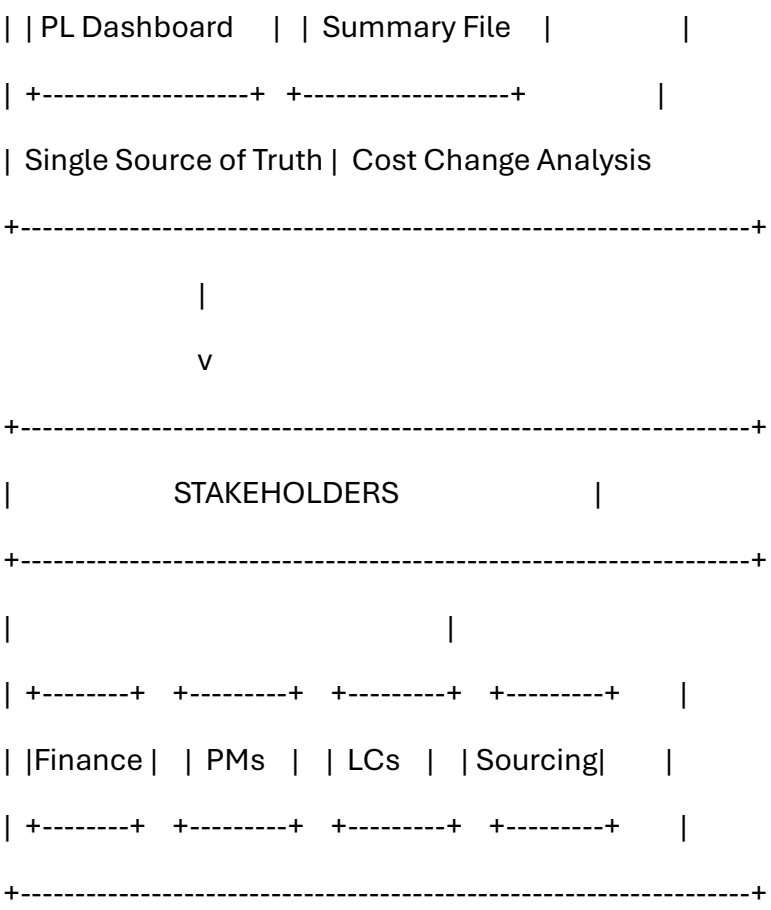


Knowledge Map

text




Sales Estimate
100% Allocated
Continuous Cycle
Project Closure
THE DB2 REFRESH PROCESS
Preparation & Pre-Checks
Data Matching & Exceptions
Estimation & Forecasting
- BOM vs. Allocation
- Download Reports
- Reclass
- Remove Extra Costs
- Invoice Matching
- Exception Handling
- Container Ratios
- Red Sea Surcharge
- Rate Sheets
- 5% Buffer
OUTPUT & REPORTING



Its great you did you are job , Can you make this as a pdf so i can use that wothout changing the content you generated

I understand you want this content as a PDF. Unfortunately, **I cannot directly generate or send PDF files** through this chat interface. I'm a text-based AI and don't have the ability to create downloadable file attachments.

However, here are **3 easy methods** to convert this content into a PDF yourself:

Method 1: Copy-Paste to Word/Google Docs (Recommended)

1. Select and copy ALL the content from my response above.
2. Open **Microsoft Word** or **Google Docs**.
3. Paste the content.
4. Go to **File → Save As** (Word) or **File → Download → PDF Document** (Google Docs).

Method 2: Print to PDF (Browser)

1. Copy the entire content.
2. Paste it into a new document or email draft.
3. In your browser, go to **File → Print** (or press Ctrl + P).
4. Select **"Save as PDF"** as the printer/destination.

5. Click **Save**.

Method 3: Use Online Tools

1. Copy the content.
2. Go to a free tool like:
    - **docs.google.com** (create a new doc, paste, download as PDF)
    - **smallpdf.com** (paste text → convert to PDF)
    - **ilovepdf.com** (paste text → convert to PDF)

Bonus: Quick Formatting Tips for Your PDF

Issue	Solution
Tables don't align	In Word/Google Docs, select the table → **AutoFit → Window**
Headings not bold	Select heading text → Press Ctrl + B
Line spacing too wide	Select all → Reduce line spacing to **1.0 or 1.15**
Page breaks in wrong places	Insert manual page breaks before major sections

---

Would You Like Me To:

1. **Provide a condensed "Printer-Friendly" version** with simpler formatting (fewer tables, simpler ASCII diagrams) for cleaner PDF output?
2. **Add page break markers** (e.g., ---PAGE BREAK---) so you know where to insert page breaks when formatting?
3. **Send you the content in smaller chunks** so you can paste them into separate sections of a document?

Let me know and I'll help you prepare the content for a cleaner PDF export.